application more resilient by adopting patterns like timeouts, retries, and failovers using the Reactor operators `timeout()`, `retryWhen()`, and `onError()`.

8.3.1 Service-to-service communication in Spring

As per the 15-Factor methodology, any backing service should be attached to an application through resource binding. For databases, you relied on the configuration properties provided by Spring Boot to specify credentials and the URL. When a backing service is another application, you need to provide its URL in a similar way. Following the externalized configuration principle, the URL should be configurable, not hardcoded. In Spring, you can achieve that through a `@ConfigurationProperties` bean, as you learned in chapter 4.

In the Order Service project, add a `ClientProperties` record in the `com.polarbookshop.orderservice.config` package. There, define your custom `polar.catalog-service-uri` property to configure the URI for calling the Catalog Service.

Listing 8.16 Defining a custom property for the Catalog Service URI

```
package com.polarbookshop.orderservice.config;

import java.net.URI;
import javax.validation.constraints.NotNull;
import org.springframework.boot.context.properties.ConfigurationProperties;

@ConfigurationProperties(prefix = "polar")    ❶
public record ClientProperties(

  @NotNull
  URI catalogServiceUri                       ❷
){}
```

❶ The prefix for the custom properties